



Faster and faster

Single, two-eared wheel
nut for quick replacement

Mercedes-Benz W196 Germany 1954

Removable steering
wheel

Large 53-gal (200-liter) gas tank
carries 50 percent methanol

Large stabilizing fin

Maserati 250F Italy 1954

Jaguar D-type UK 1956

Aston Martin DBR1 UK 1956

Driver's headrest

This
Formula 1 racer
won **8 Grand
Prix** between
1954 and 1960.

Huffaker-Offenhauser Special USA 1964

Roll bar to protect
driver if car turns over

Race car design developed greatly from the 1950s onward. Engineers and designers were constantly looking for improvements to increase speed, enhance handling, and boost performance in order to be the first to cross the finish line.

Track racing began in the 1950s with mostly front-engined race cars, such as the **Maserati 250F** and the **Mercedes-Benz W196**, which won the Formula 1 (F1) Championships in 1954 and 1955. By the end of the 1950s, rear-mounted engines became all the rage in